Transocean Ltd

Business Development Dossier

Industry	**Offshore Drilling / Energy Services**
Revenue	**$3.9B**
Employees	**7,500**
Ideal Customer Profile Score	**93**

ICP SCORING MODEL

`ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit    (max 100)`

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% | <90d: 30% | <180d: 20% | older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	$500M-$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below $500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 | Above $10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) | 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	Transocean Ltd.
Headquarters	Steinhausen, Switzerland
Founded	1953

Ownership

Public (NYSE: RIG); widely held institutional ownership. Post-Valaris merger: all-stock transaction creating combined entity. Keelan Adamson will lead as CEO.

Footprint

Global deepwater drilling operations: Gulf of Mexico, Brazil, West Africa, North Sea, Southeast Asia, India, Mediterranean. Rigs operate in some of the world's most demanding environments. Combined fleet post-merger will be the world's largest.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

Transocean is the world's largest offshore drilling contractor, operating a fleet of high-specification drillships and semisubmersibles for deepwater oil and gas exploration. Headquartered in Steinhausen, Switzerland, Transocean announced a $5.8B all-stock merger with Valaris in early 2026 - creating a 'disciplined duopoly' in deepwater drilling with a combined backlog of ~$10B. Simultaneously managing a CEO transition, fleet restructuring (retiring 9 rigs), and $5.68B in debt.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Transocean Ltd's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue: Projected $3.8-3.95B in 2026 contract drilling revenue; 89% tied to firm contracts providing visibility.

Profitability: Free cash flow surged to $626M in 2025. Operating margins improving with fleet rationalization (retiring lower-spec rigs, focusing on high-day-rate 7th-gen drillships).

Debt: $5.68B total debt - a major overhang. Retired $1.2B in 2025 ($500M above scheduled maturities). Balance sheet repair is a top priority.

Backlog: Standalone Transocean ~$6.1B; combined with Valaris ~$10B. Provides multi-year revenue visibility.

Analyst Sentiment: The Valaris merger announcement 'sent shockwaves through the energy sector.' Creates a 'disciplined duopoly' that could improve industry pricing power. Debt level remains the key investor concern.

Key Pressures: $5.68B debt constraining strategic flexibility; oil price volatility affecting customer capex decisions;

fleet restructuring (retiring 9 rigs) creates operational disruption; deepwater drilling faces ESG/environmental scrutiny; Valaris merger integration risk.

Key Tailwinds: Deepwater demand recovering (national energy security priorities); combined backlog $10B provides visibility; fleet rationalization improving margins; duopoly market structure should support dayrate discipline.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

SVP of Operations - SVP Global Operations [INFERRED] [PRIORITY TARGET]

Oversees global fleet operations across multiple deepwater basins

Outreach rationale: Owns the operational integration with Valaris - merging two global drilling fleets with different safety standards, maintenance practices, crew cultures, and operational procedures. In offshore drilling, integration failures can mean environmental disasters. This leader needs McChrystal's operational coordination framework the most.

Chief Integration Officer - SVP Integration / Corporate Development [INFERRED] [PRIORITY TARGET]

Will lead the Valaris merger integration workstreams across operations, finance, HR, technology, and fleet management

Outreach rationale: Directly responsible for the $5.8B merger integration - the largest in offshore drilling history. Must coordinate fleet rationalization, crew integration, safety standard harmonization, customer contract management, and back-office consolidation simultaneously. This is where McChrystal's multi-domain coordination expertise creates maximum value.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Keelan Adamson - Chief Executive Officer

30-year Transocean veteran who started on the drill floor; rose through operations. Deep operational credibility.

Mark Mey - Executive Vice President & CFO [INFERRED]

Financial leadership through debt reduction and merger financial structuring

VP Human Resources / Chief People Officer - VP HR [INFERRED]

Managing workforce integration across two global drilling companies

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Transocean Ltd operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Global operations organized by geographic basin (Gulf of Mexico, Brazil, West Africa, North Sea, etc.) with corporate functions (Finance, HR, Legal, Safety) centralized in Steinhausen and Houston. Post-merger: must integrate Valaris's parallel geographic and functional structure into a combined operating model - doubling organizational complexity overnight.

Culture Signals

Safety-First Operations Culture: Offshore drilling is one of the most safety-critical industries. Both Transocean and Valaris have strong safety cultures - but they're different safety cultures (different procedures, reporting systems, training programs, safety metrics). Harmonizing safety culture is non-negotiable and takes years.

Drill-Floor-to-Boardroom CEO: Keelan Adamson's 30-year career starting on the drill floor gives him credibility that typical corporate CEOs lack. He understands operations viscerally. This creates cultural alignment but may also create bias toward operational over organizational thinking.

Merger Anxiety: Two companies that have been fierce competitors must now become one. Employees on both sides fear job losses, cultural dominance by the other, and loss of identity. The 'disciplined duopoly' narrative may not resonate on the rig floor.

Cyclical Industry Scars: The offshore drilling industry went through a brutal downturn (2014-2020) that decimated the workforce. Remaining employees are resilient but skeptical of corporate optimism. Trust must be earned through execution, not presentations.

Glassdoor: [INFERRED] Offshore workers value safety culture, compensation, and rotation schedules. Corporate employees value stability and leadership clarity. Both will be disrupted by the merger.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Transocean Ltd.

1. 2026-02-01 - Announced $5.8B all-stock merger with Valaris - creating world's largest offshore drilling company

The largest merger in offshore drilling history creates unprecedented organizational integration challenge - two global companies, different cultures, different fleets, safety-critical operations

2. 2025-12-01 - Keelan Adamson appointed CEO, succeeding Jeremy Thigpen

New CEO brings operational credibility (30-year veteran, started on drill floor) but must also lead the most complex corporate integration in company history

3. 2025-10-01 - Announced retirement of 9 rigs by mid-2026; fleet rationalization to focus on 24 high-spec rigs

Fleet restructuring requires workforce adjustments, asset disposition, and customer contract management - all before the Valaris merger adds more complexity

4. 2025-12-01 - Retired $1.2B of debt in 2025 ($500M above scheduled maturities); free cash flow hit $626M

Financial discipline creates credibility for merger financing but $5.68B remaining debt constrains post-merger integration investment

5. 2026-02-01 - Combined Transocean-Valaris backlog expected to reach ~$10B

Massive backlog means the combined company must execute customer contracts flawlessly through integration - no room for operational disruption

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

> *The $5.8B merger is the largest in offshore drilling history - creating unprecedented integration complexity in a safety-critical industry. New CEO creates openness to external support. Revenue $3.9B+ supports premium advisory. The safety dimension is McChrystal's unique differentiator - no other advisory firm combines organizational transformation expertise with credibility in high-consequence operational environments. The military-to-drilling cultural bridge (discipline, safety, operational excellence) is genuine and resonant.*

Primary Problem

Integrating two global offshore drilling companies - each with thousands of employees on rigs worldwide, different safety cultures, different fleet management practices, and different operational procedures - while maintaining the safety-critical operational performance that customers and regulators demand, and managing $5.68B in debt.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

High-stakes operational coordination in safety-critical environments - this is McChrystal's most differentiated capability. The merger of two offshore drilling fleets, where integration failures can mean environmental disasters and loss of life, demands the exact operational discipline McChrystal built in special operations. No strategy firm can credibly claim expertise in coordinating safety-critical operations at global scale.

Likely Objections to Engagement

Offshore drilling is a highly specialized industry - does McChrystal understand it?
We're focused on financial integration and debt reduction, not organizational design
Merger hasn't closed yet - too early for integration advisory
Swiss/Houston headquarters creates geographic complexity for advisory engagement

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey Energy Practice - energy industry M&A integration
Deloitte - large-scale merger integration and technology systems
Bain - PE-style value creation and synergy capture
Industry-specific: offshore drilling operational consultants (various niche firms)

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. As you plan the Valaris integration, how are you thinking about harmonizing two different safety cultures - when both companies believe their approach is the right one?

Lead with safety - the most important issue in offshore drilling and the one where integration failures have the most severe consequences. Shows McChrystal understands what matters.

2. With 24+ contracted rigs operating worldwide during the integration, how do you maintain operational performance on the rig floor while the corporate organization is being restructured above them?

Surface the core tension of safety-critical mergers: the people doing the dangerous work can't be distracted by organizational change. McChrystal's operating model insulates operations while enabling integration.

Recommended Meeting Framing

Frame as a conversation about what McChrystal learned from integrating special operations units during wartime - when the mission can't stop while the organization transforms. The parallel to offshore drilling is genuine: people doing dangerous, important work on remote platforms while the corporate organization above them changes. Military credibility is a significant advantage in the energy/drilling culture.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Transocean Ltd's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Position: Transocean is the most recognized name in deepwater drilling - the company that operates the world's most advanced drillships. Post-merger, the combined entity will be the dominant force in deepwater.

Brand Risk: The Deepwater Horizon disaster (2010, operated by Transocean for BP) remains part of the company's brand history. Any safety incident during the Valaris integration would be catastrophic - both operationally and reputationally. The integration must not compromise safety.

Brand Evolution: From 'largest offshore driller' to 'disciplined duopoly' - the post-merger positioning emphasizes market discipline over market dominance. This requires organizational discipline to match the brand promise.

McChrystal Connection: The brand promise of 'safe, reliable deepwater drilling' is entirely dependent on operational coordination. In an industry where the Deepwater Horizon shadow persists, the organizational coordination that prevents the next incident is the most important brand investment Transocean can make.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Transocean Ltd. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Safety-Critical Merger Integration

Merging two offshore drilling companies is fundamentally different from merging two banks or two software companies. On a drilling rig, organizational confusion can cause blowouts, injuries, and environmental disasters. McChrystal's military experience in high-consequence operational integration is uniquely differentiated - no strategy firm can match the credibility of coordinating operations where people's lives are at stake. McKinsey handles M&A strategy; McChrystal ensures the integration doesn't create safety gaps on the rig floor.

Fit Dimension 2: Global Distributed Operations Coordination

Transocean-Valaris will operate 30+ high-specification rigs across Gulf of Mexico, Brazil, West Africa, North Sea, Southeast Asia, and India - each operating semi-autonomously under different regulatory regimes, different weather conditions, and different customer requirements. McChrystal's Team of Teams model was designed for globally distributed, semi-autonomous units that must coordinate without centralized control. The analogy to military forward operating bases is direct.

Fit Dimension 3: Competitor-to-Partner Cultural Transformation

Transocean and Valaris have competed directly for customers, talent, and market position. Now they must become one team. McChrystal's experience integrating different military units (each with their own traditions, cultures, and rivalries) into a unified force is the direct analog.

Fit Dimension 4: Debt-Constrained Transformation

With $5.68B in debt, every integration dollar must create value. McChrystal's lean operating model (cadences, information flow, decision architecture) delivers organizational effectiveness without the overhead of large-scale IT system integrations or management restructuring programs. High impact, lower cost.

9b. Cumulative Case - Why Transocean Is the Top Pipeline Opportunity

Transocean represents the highest-stakes organizational integration in the pipeline: a $5.8B merger of safety-critical global operations, with a new CEO, fleet restructuring, $5.68B in debt, and the Deepwater Horizon shadow. Signal chain: Deepwater demand recovery -> fleet rationalization -> CEO transition -> $5.8B Valaris merger -> combined $10B backlog -> safety culture harmonization required -> global operational integration across 5+ continents. Every signal amplifies the organizational complexity and consequence of failure.

Revenue Potential: $500K-$600K initial engagement (safety-critical integration coordination design), expandable to $1.5M-$2M for enterprise-wide integration execution across operations and corporate functions, with $400K-$600K ongoing for integration cadence management through full operational integration. Total: $2.5M-$3.5M over 24-36 months. This is the highest-value single engagement in the pipeline.

9c. Enterprise Issues & Organizational Challenges

1. Safety Culture Harmonization: Two companies with different safety procedures, reporting systems, investigation methodologies, and training programs must converge to a single standard - without creating any gap in safety performance during the transition. This is the highest-stakes integration workstream.

2. Fleet Integration Complexity: 30+ rigs of different specifications, ages, and configurations. Crew assignments, maintenance schedules, spare parts inventories, and operational procedures must be standardized or explicitly managed as different. Each rig is a mini-organization with its own dynamics.

3. Competitor-to-Partner Identity Shift: Employees who spent careers competing against the other company must now collaborate. Tribalism, distrust, and 'our way is better' dynamics are inevitable. Without deliberate cultural integration, parallel organizations persist inside the combined company.

4. Customer Contract Management During Integration: Customers (oil majors like Shell, BP, ExxonMobil) have contracts with specific rigs and crews. Any disruption to contract performance - crew changes, maintenance delays, communication lapses - risks customer relationships worth hundreds of millions.

5. Geographic Regulatory Complexity: Rigs operate under different regulatory regimes in every geography. Integration must account for regulatory differences in safety, labor, environmental, and maritime law across 10+ countries.

6. Debt Overhang Constraining Integration Investment: $5.68B in debt means the integration must be capital-efficient. Cannot spend freely on IT system integration, consulting armies, or generous retention packages.

7. Leadership Consolidation: Two complete C-suites, two sets of geographic leaders, two sets of functional heads. The selection of who stays and who leaves - and the speed of that decision - determines whether the combined organization gels or fractures.

8. Offshore Worker Morale and Retention: Rig workers are highly specialized and in demand. Integration uncertainty causes the best people to leave first. Retention during the integration period is critical and requires clear, honest communication to people who work on remote platforms with limited connectivity.

9d. Expected Outcomes from McChrystal Group Engagement

1. Safety-First Integration Architecture: Integration coordination framework that ensures zero safety gaps during merger execution. Measurable: zero lost-time incidents caused by integration-related confusion.

2. Global Operations Coordination Cadence: Operating rhythm connecting 30+ rigs, multiple shore bases, and corporate functions across time zones. Measurable: integration milestones on-track with <10% variance.

3. Rig-Level Integration Support: Cultural integration program designed for the unique environment of offshore rigs (remote, rotation-based, high-stress). Measurable: rig-level employee engagement surveys maintained within 10% of pre-merger baseline.

4. Customer Contract Continuity: Coordination mechanisms ensuring seamless contract performance during integration. Measurable: zero customer SLA violations caused by integration activities.

5. Fleet Rationalization Execution: Coordinated retirement of 9 rigs while maintaining contractual commitments. Measurable: all rig retirements completed on schedule without customer disruption.

6. Combined Safety Standard: Harmonized safety culture, procedures, and reporting across the combined fleet. Measurable: single safety management system operational within 12 months.

7. Retention of Critical Talent: Communication and engagement framework for offshore workers during integration. Measurable: <5% unplanned attrition of critical operational personnel.

9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

CEO

Leader: Keelan Adamson
Role: Combined entity leadership; 30-year veteran
McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor; operational credibility

CFO

Leader: Mark Mey [INFERRED]
Role: Financial integration, debt management
McChrystal Relevance: Budget gatekeeper; synergy capture

Global Operations

Leader: SVP Operations [INFERRED]
Role: Fleet operations across all basins
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Safety-critical integration

Integration Office

Leader: CIO [To be appointed]
Role: Merger integration workstreams
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Integration coordination

Gulf of Mexico

Leader: [Basin Leader]
Role: Largest operating region
McChrystal Relevance: Key integration theater

Brazil

Leader: [Basin Leader]
Role: Growing deepwater market
McChrystal Relevance: Regulatory complexity

West Africa / North Sea

Leader: [Basin Leaders]
Role: Mature deepwater basins
McChrystal Relevance: Cultural integration across geographies

HR / People

Leader: VP HR [INFERRED]
Role: Workforce integration, retention
McChrystal Relevance: Rig worker communication and engagement

Safety

Leader: VP HSE [INFERRED]
Role: Safety culture harmonization

McChrystal Relevance: Most consequential integration workstream

Valaris Leadership

Leader: [CEO/COO]
Role: Counter-party leadership during integration
McChrystal Relevance: Cultural bridge; trust building

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Strategic Signal Convergence - Why Now: Deepwater demand recovery -> fleet rationalization -> CEO transition -> $5.8B Valaris merger -> $10B combined backlog -> safety culture harmonization -> global operational integration. This is the most consequential organizational transformation in the offshore drilling industry in decades. The 6-12 month integration planning and execution window is the highest-leverage moment. Every week of delay accumulates organizational risk.

The Structural Paradox - Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: McKinsey's Energy Practice advises on M&A strategy and synergy targets. Deloitte handles IT integration and system consolidation. But neither has credibility in safety-critical operational coordination. McChrystal is the only advisory firm that can say: 'We coordinated distributed, high-consequence operations across multiple theaters where integration failures meant loss of life.' The military-to-drilling bridge is not a metaphor - it's a direct capability transfer. Keelan Adamson (30-year drill floor veteran) will respect this credibility in a way no strategy consultant could earn.

Phased Engagement Hypothesis - Land and Expand:

- Phase 1 (Months 1-4, $500K-$600K): Safety-Critical Integration Architecture - design the integration coordination framework that ensures zero safety gaps; build the global operating rhythm for 30+ rigs; pilot with one geographic basin (Gulf of Mexico). Beachhead: safety integration - it's non-negotiable, it's the highest-risk workstream, and it's where McChrystal's credibility is strongest.
- Phase 2 (Months 5-12, $1M-$1.5M): Enterprise-wide integration deployment - all geographic basins, corporate function integration, fleet rationalization coordination, and customer contract management.
- Phase 3 (Months 13-36, $400K-$600K retainer): Ongoing integration cadence management through full operational integration. Safety culture monitoring. Rig-level cultural integration program.

Competitive Displacement Strategy: Don't compete with McKinsey on synergy strategy or Deloitte on IT integration. Own the operational coordination layer - the part where organizational failure has physical consequences. Frame: 'McKinsey tells you what to integrate. Deloitte integrates your systems. McChrystal ensures no one gets hurt in the process.' This positioning is unchallengeable.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit Map:

- Thread 1: SVP Operations - safety-critical integration. Angle: "How are you harmonizing Transocean and Valaris safety procedures before Day 1?" Appeal: this is the highest-stakes issue and the one where McChrystal's credibility is strongest.
- Thread 2: Chief Integration Officer (once appointed) - integration coordination. Angle: "What's your coordination architecture for managing 30+ rig operations across 5 continents during integration?" Appeal: this person needs a framework they don't have time to build from scratch.
- Thread 3: Keelan Adamson (CEO) - executive sponsor via military/veteran network. A 30-year operational veteran who started on the drill floor will respect McChrystal's military operational credibility more than any strategy consultant's credentials.

- Warm Introduction Vectors: Military/veteran connections in energy industry (many former military in offshore drilling); energy industry conference proximity (OTC, SPE conferences in Houston); McChrystal personal network in defense/energy intersection; Houston energy business community.